

TravelEase - Safety Guide for Northern Pakistan

Northern Pakistan is a welcoming destination for travelers. Following these safety guidelines will help ensure your trip is smooth and memorable.

GENERAL SAFETY

- **Travel Insurance:** Always have comprehensive travel insurance that covers medical emergencies and trekking activities.
- **Stay Informed:** Be aware of the local weather conditions, especially before a long journey or trek.
- **Valuables:** Keep your valuables like passports, money, and electronics secure and out of plain sight.

HEALTH & ALTITUDE SICKNESS

- **Acclimatize:** When traveling to high-altitude areas like Hunza, Skardu, or Babusar Top, allow your body 1-2 days to acclimatize before engaging in strenuous activity.
- **Stay Hydrated:** Drink plenty of water (3-4 liters a day) to help prevent Acute Mountain Sickness (AMS).
- **Know the Symptoms:** Symptoms of AMS include headache, nausea, dizziness, and shortness of breath. If symptoms persist or worsen, descend to a lower altitude immediately.
- **Food & Water:** Drink bottled or purified water. Eat freshly cooked meals to avoid stomach issues.

TREKKING & HIKING

- **Hire a Local Guide:** For any serious trek, always hire a certified local guide. They know the terrain, weather, and safe routes.
- **Never Hike Alone:** Always travel with a companion or group.
- **Inform Someone:** Let your hotel or a contact person know your trekking plan and expected return time.
- **Stick to the Trail:** Do not wander off marked trails.

ROAD TRAVEL

- **Choose Reliable Transport:** Use reputable companies for renting vehicles. Ensure the driver is experienced in mountainous terrain.
- **Avoid Night Travel:** Road travel at night in mountainous areas is not recommended due to poor visibility and potential hazards.

RESPECT FOR LOCAL CULTURE

- **Dress Modestly:** Especially when visiting mosques, shrines, or conservative local communities. Both men and women should aim to cover their shoulders and knees.

- **Ask for Permission:** Always ask for permission before taking photographs of people, especially women.
- **Be Respectful:** The people of Northern Pakistan are known for their hospitality. Be polite, patient, and respectful of their traditions and way of life.